

Room booking and scheduling system

Questions in regards to what the students need when it comes to a convenient, easy to use system to book study spaces.

Full Names *

Nqobile Mvambi

Student Number *

52547469

What is your primary role in relation to booking a study space within your institution? *

I'm a student who requires study space.

What tasks do you perform to book a study space that a system should support? *

Search for available rooms by building, date and time.

Check capacity for 10 people.

Book the room.

Receive confirmation SMS or email.

View alternative rooms if my first choice is taken. Save a booking as draft and confirm later.

What information do you need access to most frequently, and in what format? *

Real-time room availability, room location/building, seating capacity, and booking time slots. In a simple calendar list format on my phone, plus SMS confirmation after booking.

What are the most common problems with your current process? *

No central system, we walk around campus to check if rooms are free.

Rooms get double booked.

We waste 30min-1hr looking.

No way to see alternatives.

No confirmation, so sometimes someone else takes the room.

What would make your work significantly easier if a system could do it? *

An online system where I can see all available rooms instantly, book with 3 clicks, get SMS confirmation, and see suggested alternative buildings or time slots if my choice is unavailable.

What do you struggle with most when making a booking? *

Finding out if a room is actually available. There's no central system so rooms get double-booked and I waste time walking around campus checking.

How do you feel about having your personal information on a website online? *

I'm okay with it as long as the website is secure and only uses my information for booking confirmations. I don't want my details shared with anyone else.

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Full Names *

Naomi Radebe

Student Number *

34734775

What is your primary role in relation to booking a study space within your institution? *

Student

What tasks do you perform to book a study space that a system should support? *

The details of the student, location, time, date and number of people that will be utilising the space

What information do you need access to most frequently, and in what format? *

Buildings that have available study spaces and the time slots showing availability

What are the most common problems with your current process? *

The time slots are usually fully booked

What would make your work significantly easier if a system could do it? *

The system can show available slots available monthly rather than weekly

What do you struggle with most when making a booking? *

Finding suitable timeslot and forgetting my booking

How do you feel about having your personal information on a website online? *

It will save time of booking the study spaces face to face

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Full Names *

Neo Masebe

Student Number *

36703168

What is your primary role in relation to booking a study space within your institution? *

Administrator of the RBSS

What tasks do you perform to book a study space that a system should support? *

Automatic display of all available study rooms should be supported as this makes it easier as opposed to having to manually search through to find available spaces.

What information do you need access to most frequently, and in what format? *

Important information I need as an administrator is the booking trends -- how frequently each study room is booked, what are the peak periods, how many students occupy the rooms per period. The information would ideally be in an excel spreadsheet or csv file.

What are the most common problems with your current process? *

The current process is manual and thus often slow and requires a lot of input from the current booking manager. The process is not detailed enough and as a result there are booking conflicts and such.

What would make your work significantly easier if a system could do it? *

The system should be able to gather information on booking trends and resolve scheduling issues automatically without input from booking managers.

What do you struggle with most when making a booking? *

Manually filtering the bookings to find available slots is a tedious and unreliable process.

How do you feel about having your personal information on a website online? *

As long as the website has proper security protocols and complies with the POPIA act guidelines then having personal information on a website is not an issue.

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Full Names *

Thobeka Cele

Student Number *

45444145

What is your primary role in relation to booking a study space within your institution? *

Student

What tasks do you perform to book a study space that a system should support? *

The system should allow me to register and look for available study space and a specific time slot i need

What information do you need access to most frequently, and in what format? *

I need to see which rooms are available, room location, capacity, and available time slots. I prefer to see this in a calendar or timetable view on my phone.

What are the most common problems with your current process? *

If I could book online instantly, get a confirmation email/WhatsApp, receive reminders before my booking, and cancel or reschedule myself.

What would make your work significantly easier if a system could do it? *

We do not have an online booking system. It is hard to know if a room is free, and there is no confirmation after booking.

What do you struggle with most when making a booking? *

If I could book online instantly, get a confirmation email/WhatsApp, receive reminders before my booking, and cancel or reschedule myself.

How do you feel about having your personal information on a website online? *

I am comfortable with it as long as my name, student number and email are kept private, secure, and only used for booking purposes.

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